

EXTREME Looksmaxing Secret: Go Keto

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Aug 08, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AHbpfV4DqVc> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter makes the case that the ketogenic diet is the ultimate looksmaxing tool — clearing acne, reducing wrinkles, stripping water weight, raising testosterone, and suppressing hunger — backed by personal experience and cited studies.

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Origin Story: Modeling in New York & Accidental Keto 0:00

- Brandon was working for a moving company in New York when he was scouted by one of the biggest modeling agencies
 - The scout handed him a card on the spot and told him to go to a casting immediately
 - The casting was for **Vibe Magazine** — he booked it and was paid \$500 for the shoot
- The agency told him he was "a little too big and bulky" and needed to slim down to book more jobs
 - He instinctively adopted what was essentially a ketogenic diet without labeling it as such
 - His diet consisted almost entirely of green vegetables (spinach, kale, salads) and meat
- Two outcomes followed immediately:
 - He slimmed down as required
 - His chronic acne cleared up dramatically
- The result: magazine covers, being flown internationally for modeling and fashion shows, walking **New York Fashion Week**

- He stopped keto when he stopped modeling and didn't return to it for years
- **11 years ago** he deliberately restarted the ketogenic diet and observed the same effects again
 - Skin cleared up, looked leaner and more shredded, reduced water retention
 - People consistently say he looks younger than his age (44) or younger than he did in his early 30s

Benefit 1: Clears Acne & Skin 1:31

- Claims keto has been **proven to cure acne** and points to "tons of studies" on this topic
- His own skincare routine is essentially nothing — he washes his face with whatever bar soap is in the shower
 - Dismisses influencer-marketed skincare creams and serums as unnecessary if you go keto
- Mechanism explained:
 - On a ketogenic diet, blood glucose is stable and low
 - Acne is fundamentally an **inflammatory condition**
 - Lower, stable glucose = less systemic inflammation = clearer skin
- References **Looksmaxxer "Kicular"** who reportedly takes Accutane for skin issues, suggesting keto would have been sufficient
- Recommendation: "Go keto for a month — your face will be impeccable, immaculate."

Benefit 2: Reduces Wrinkles by Protecting Collagen 2:38

- Studies show that **glucose and glycogen degrade collagen**
 - Less collagen = more wrinkles — this is the primary mechanism of age-related skin wrinkling
- On a ketogenic diet, glucose levels are consistently low and stable
 - Excess glucose/glycogen is not circulating in the bloodstream and therefore cannot break down collagen
- Personal evidence: at 44, he says he occasionally sees someone online claiming to be his age and is struck by the contrast in appearance
 - His explanation: "I've been keto for 11 years. Of course I don't."

Benefit 3: Reduces Water Weight for a Chiseled Look 3:00

- Keto significantly and reliably reduces water retention
- Visual impact of losing water weight:
 - Abs become more visible
 - Serratus muscles become defined
 - Obliques sharpen
 - Face looks more angular and hollow-cheeked rather than round or puffy
- Brandon acknowledges he has a naturally rounder/oval face shape and uses keto specifically to counteract that tendency

- "If I gain water weight, I'm going to look like an emoji."
- Addresses the common dismissal "it's just water weight":
 - Studies show keto also outperforms regular diets for **actual fat loss** when protein and calories are equated
 - Water weight loss is not trivial — it directly affects how lean and defined you appear
- Claim: "If you go keto for a week, you will have a tighter face."

Benefit 4: Raises Testosterone 4:09

- Addresses and rejects the common rumor that keto lowers testosterone
 - Points to studies showing keto **actually raises testosterone**
- Higher testosterone benefits for looksmaxing:
 - Faster fat loss
 - Faster muscle building
- Personal note: Brandon himself is on **Testosterone Replacement Therapy (TRT)** but attributes this to age (44), not keto
 - States every man's total testosterone begins declining at **age 30** regardless of diet
 - Notes that the vast majority of men on TRT are carb eaters — not keto dieters — because almost nobody sustains keto long-term
 - Claims he has met fewer than 10 people who have maintained keto as long as he has

Benefit 5: Boosts Immune System 5:18

- Animal studies show ketogenic diet significantly extends lifespan and improves immune function
 - Acknowledges no equivalent human trials yet
- Offers extensive personal anecdotal data across 11 years:
 - Has not had a cold, not even the sniffles, in **11 years**
 - His girlfriend contracted COVID-19 three times; he lived with her, kissed her, had close physical contact, ate off her plate — and **never once tested positive**
 - Was testing himself multiple times per week (required by his son's mother before visits) — consistently negative
 - Attended a mastermind event where **90% of attendees got COVID** — he shook hands and spoke face-to-face with everyone, still tested negative
 - His son sneezed directly into his mouth while sick with COVID — still did not test positive
- Frames immune health as a looksmaxing issue: "If you're sick, you ain't looksmaxing."

"I was at a super spreader event and I shook hands with literally everyone... My son sneezed in my mouth while he had COVID. I did not even test positive."

Benefit 6: Superior Fat Loss & Hunger Suppression 6:56

- Reiterates that **90% of looksmaxing is simply getting lean**
- New study cited: when calories and protein were held equal, keto participants lost **significantly more weight** than the control group
- Hunger suppression mechanism:
 - Ketogenic diet naturally suppresses appetite, making diet adherence easier
 - Describes it as **"nature's Ozempic" / "nature's GLP"** — a natural GLP-1 analog effect
 - Compares it to tirzepatide (Mounjaro/Zepbound): not as strong, but similar direction of effect without injections or drug side effects
- Long-term safety:
 - Human studies confirm keto is **safe for long-term use**
 - Dismisses the claim that keto should only be done short-term
 - "You don't have to marry it like me, but you can definitely do it long term."

Historical Context: Keto Was Invented for Children 8:02

- The ketogenic diet was **invented in 1920 by doctors** specifically for children with epilepsy
 - Pharmaceuticals available at the time were too harsh for children's bodies
 - Doctors observed that when children had less glucose and began producing ketones, the ketones were neuroprotective
 - Seizures stopped — ketones actively helped heal epilepsy
- Keto remained the **standard of care for pediatric epilepsy** until newer, easier-to-administer drugs were developed
 - Primary reason for the switch: dietary adherence is very difficult for children ("You're going to tell a child he can't eat candy?")
- Key point: if the diet was developed for children and considered safe enough as medical treatment, long-term use in healthy adults is well-supported

Bonus: Cognitive Benefits of Ketones 8:47

- Some studies suggest keto **boosts cognitive function** because ketones are a preferred fuel source for the brain
- Brandon mentions this briefly and self-deprecatingly sets it aside: "Fuck the brain stuff — you're here for looksmaxing."

Summary & Free Tool: The RIP Roadmap 9:10

- Consolidated list of keto looksmaxing benefits covered in the video:
 - Skin will be clear

- Fewer wrinkles
- Testosterone increases
- Hunger suppression aids diet adherence
- Superior fat loss vs. standard diet (calories/protein equal)
- Reduced water weight = more defined face and body
- Challenge to the viewer: "Try it for a month. Bet you look better."
- Free tool promoted: **The RIP Roadmap**
 - Input: height, weight, age, and a photo of yourself
 - Output: estimated body fat percentage, how many pounds of fat to lose to get shredded, a weekly game plan with expectations
 - Available via link in the video description
 - Cost: free